

National Averages

Annual Cost (Center-based)

\$7,222

% of Household Income

16.3%

Monthly Average

\$602

Hours of Work at Min. Wage

19

Weekly hours to afford childcare

Affordability Index

16.3

2.1% less affordable

Families Impacted

12.8M

With children under 5

Top 5 Most Expensive States

District of Columbia	\$13,560
Massachusetts	\$12,353
Rhode Island	\$11,561
New York	\$11,537
Washington	\$10,772

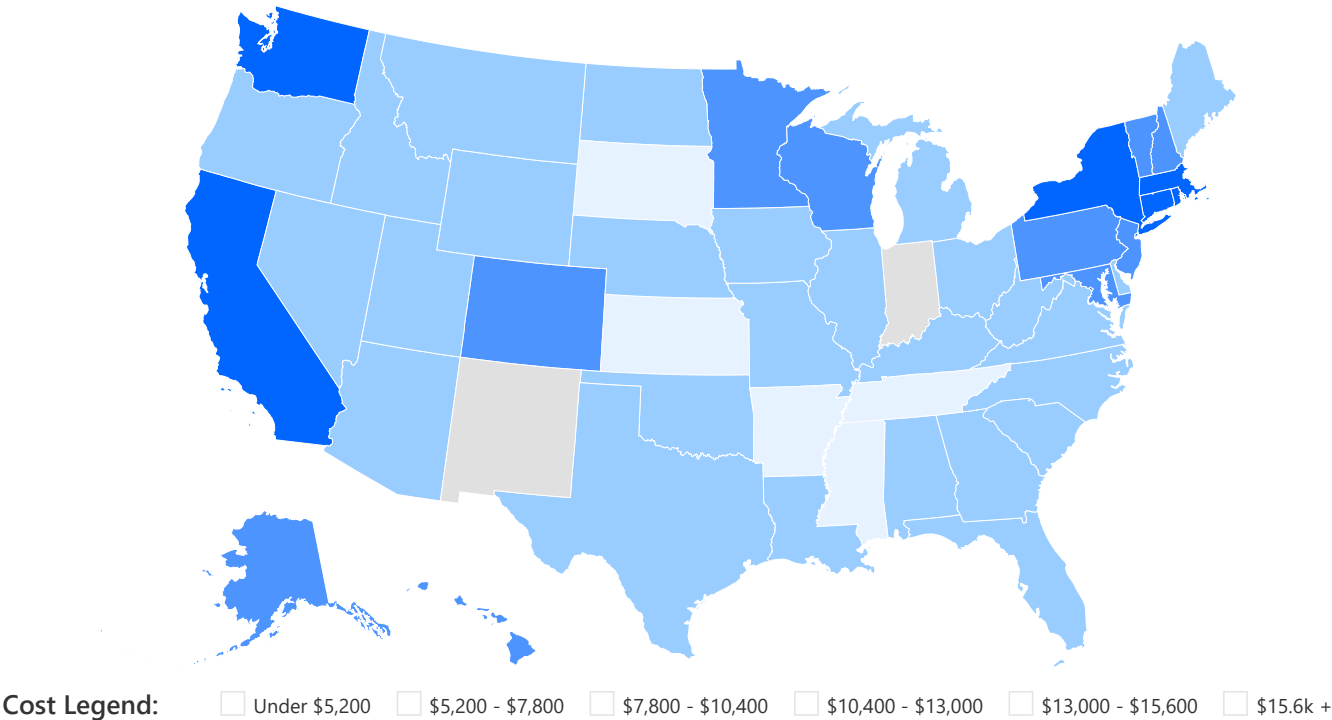
State Comparison

Select a state to compare:

Alabama

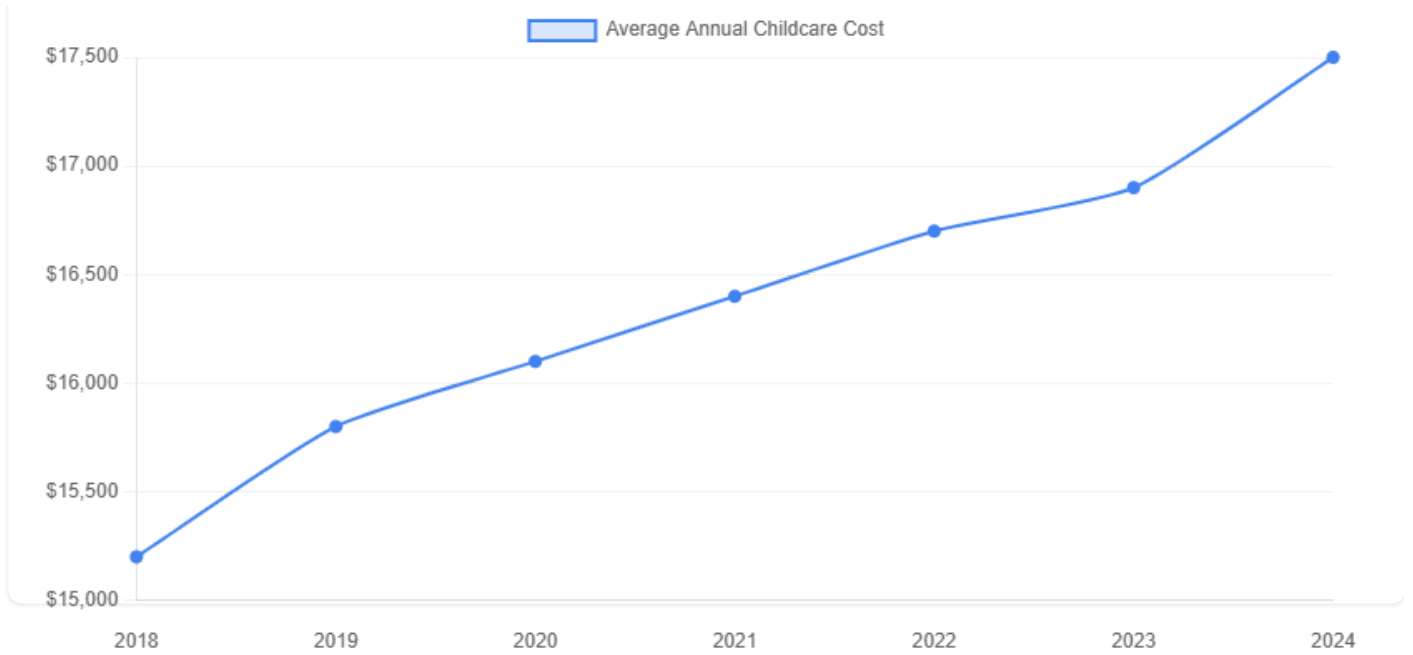
Annual Cost: \$5,207
vs National Avg: -27.9%

Average Annual Childcare Costs By State (2024)



National Childcare Cost Trends (2018-2024)

% of Median Income: 13.6%
Rank (1=most expensive): 44 of 49



Data sources: U.S. Census Bureau, Bureau of Labor Statistics, Child Care Aware of America